

part, the Cohort analysis allows you to analyse user groups that are not your current users. This is really helpful when it comes to formulating marketing strategy.

There are more features that we could talk about, but that's not the point. Google Analytics can also be harnessed in ways that are beyond the usual and give your SEO just the right boost.

Referrals

One of the most common forms of generating views and clicks nowadays is through social media. And if you are harnessing the power of Facebook, Twitter as well as online forums and more, you will be getting a lot of what is known as referral traffic.

Referral traffic is Google Analytics way of describing traffic that originates from sources other than Google's search results. If a different site links to your page, the traffic generated from that link is referral traffic. You can check this on Acquisition>All Traffic>Referral to see the sources that are generating traffic for you. This might help you decide which platforms are working for you and which platforms you need to work on.

Another thing that this information can reveal is traffic from sites apart from the ones where you are sharing. For example, if you wrote an amazing article on Tips to survive hostel life, and that was picked up by another site that features similar content. Once you can track the traffic their backlink is generating, you can reach out to them for featuring opportunities and even other arrangements for content sharing. All of this just from the traffic report you just saw!

Annotations

If you are running extensive SEO campaigns or just can't wrap your head around all the steps that you are taking to improve your page's traffic, it might get a bit confusing to keep track of what worked and what didn't. Does the traffic spike at the end of January correspond to your Adwords campaign? Was the traffic slump two months back due to site maintenance? This is where Google Analytics' hidden weapon comes into play - annotations.

Any report that you see in Google Analytics has the option to add annotations. Just click the arrow button below any time-based graph in a report to bring up the annotations panel. Click on Create New Annotation and then enter the date and details. Typically, for a website, you should record changes such as:-